

Boost Your Coding Skills with Scratch

This article provides a brief introduction to Scratch, a programming language environment used for creating 2D interactive programs for beginners to programming.



Scratch is a programming language environment developed by the Scratch Team of The Lifelong Kindergarten group at MIT Media Lab. It is used to create 2D animations, interactive games, clip art, stories and presentations. Creations can be shared with the online community. This article focuses on game development using Scratch in a fun-filled learning experience for beginners to programming, and should help to enhance coding skills as well as creativity.

Installation

System requirements

Scratch is currently available for all Linux, Windows and Mac users.

Display: 800 x 480 or larger (16-bit colour or greater)

OS: Windows 2000 or later, Mac OS X 10.4 or later, Ubuntu Linux 9.04 or later

Disk space: At least 120 megabytes of free space

Sound/Video: Sound playback requires speakers and recording requires a microphone

Scratch v1.4 can also use a USB or built-in camera.

Installation procedure (Ubuntu/Debian users)

Step 1: Download the software package for Ubuntu/Debian users from http://scratch.mit.edu/scratch_1.4/.

Step 2: Open the '.deb' file, and install with the default package installer.

Getting familiar with Scratch

A Scratch project consists of objects called 'sprites', and their corresponding commands. The commands or instructions are known as 'scripts'.

In Scratch, a sprite is a collection of images, created using the Paint Editor or imported from the hard disk. Each image